10/7/25

Glimpses

Glimpses of India

I Answer the following word meanings:-

a Dwarfing: causing to appear much smaller
sentence This tower is dwarfing every structure nearby.

b Apparent: Clearly visible or understood
sentence Her sadness was apparent despite the smile.

Winnowing

c Winnowing: Separating lighter particles from heavier ones using wind
sentence Farmers winnow grain to remove husk and chaff.

d Nostalgia: a sentimental longing for the past
sentence old songs fill me with sweet nostalgia.

e Mainstream: widely accepted ideas or activities.
sentence she prefers indie films over mainstream blockbusters.

II Answer the following Reference to Context:-

1 "Our elders----------in Goa"
a what did the narrator's elders reminice?
Ans They reminisced about the good old Portuguese days, The loaves of bread, and the cheerful, welcoming presence of the traditional bakers or "paders".

b what did the thud & jingle herald?
Ans The thud and jingle of the baker's bamboo stick heralded his arrival and signaled fresh bread delivery, exciting the children and waking the household.

c Give a synonym of 'put-off'.
Ans Synonym of 'put-off' is 'delay'.

2 "The Fiercely----------the Kurds"
a How did Kurds have a distinct culture?
Ans The Kodavus of Coorg are said to resemble Kurds in dress, wearing a long black coat called Kuppia, reflecting a possible drabic cultural descent. It is suggested a shared heritage heritage and unique identity.

b what is the meaning of Kuppia?
Ans Kuppia is a traditional long black coat worn by the Kodavus of Coorg, resembling the Kuffia worn by Arabs and Kurds, symbolizing cultural Heritage.

3 "On both----------leaves".
a Why was pruning leaves done?
Ans Pruning leaves was done to ensure the tea plants retained their freshness and flavour, making them suitable for producing high-quality tea, as described in 'Tea from Assam'.

b Describe the appearance of the group of tea pluckers?

Ans From the extract, the tea pluckers are described as doll-like women wearing plastic aprons, carrying bamboo baskets on their backs, busily plucking freshly sprouted tea leaves.

Q What sort of fresh leaves were generally plucked?

Ans Freshly sprouted tea leaves - specifically, the top two leaves and a bud - were generally plucked to ensure the best flavour and quality of the tea.

III Answer the following Short Answers:-

Q1 Who were pader? How did they announce their arrival?

Ans The pader are the traditional Goan village bakers. They announced their arrival by striking a special bamboo staff on the ground, creating a resonant "jhang-jhang" sound to alert villagers.

Q2 Why did Alexander's army decide to settle in Coorg?

Ans A section of Alexander's army moved south along the coast but, when their return became impractical, chose to settle in Coorg. They integrated with the locals - marrying Kodavas and helping shape the region's distinctive culture.

Q3 Why was Rajvir so excited?

Ans Rajvir was excited because he had never seen so much greenery before. The vast tea gardens, neatly pruned bushes, and doll-like tea pluckers amidst the scenic hills amazed him. He had read a lot about tea but was witnessing it for the first time.

Q4 What do the words stand for:

a Bol
b Kabai
c Kuffia
d Mahaseer
e Mariani

Ans a- Bol- Bread distributed in marraige.
b Kabai- Dress worn by Goan bakers backs then.
c Kuffia- Black & white cap worn by Arab.
d Mahaseer- A large freshwater fish.
e Mariani - Train Junction in Assam

IV Answer the following Long Answers:-

Q1 Describe the different legends regarding the discovery of tea leaves.

Ans Two captivating legends trace the origins of tea. The first is a chinese legend involving an emperor who was known for boiling water before drinking it. One day, while boiling water, a few leaves from nearby burning twigs accidentally fell into the pot, producing a delicious aroma and taste. These leaves were from a tea plant, and thus tea was discovered.

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The second legend comes from India and involves Bodhidharma, a Buddhist monk who meditated for years without sleeping. To stay awake, he cut off his eyelids and threw them to the ground. From those eyelids, tea plants are believed to have sprung up. Their leaves, when boiled, helped banish sleep.

These stories, though mythical, reflect tea's deep cultural roots and its journey from ancient practices to a global beverage.

Q2 Describe the role of bakers in the olden days of Goa.

Ans In olden days of Goa, bakers were central to daily life. Each dawn, they stoked wood-fired ovens and kneaded flour brought by Portuguese traders into sturdy loaves of pão and sweet bins scented with palm jaggery. The rhythmic crackle of embers and the warm glow of baking loaves marked the start of the day for townsfolk and travellers alike.

Bakers ferried their golden breads across narrow lanes in wicker baskets and bullock carts, supplying homes, markets, and fishing villages. Their wares sustained fisherman hauling in the catch, farmers tending rice paddies, and clerks poring over ledgers — bridging social divides through a shared morning meal.

Beyond everyday sustenance, Goan bakers shaped festival customs. At weddings and church feasts they presented decorative cakes and ceremonial breads, blending Portuguese recipes with Konkani flavours. Generations of artisans passed down secret yeast starters and baking techniques, forging communal bonds from their ovens' warmth.

Q3 Give theories that describe the possible descent of the people in Coorg.

Ans The descent of the people in Coorge remains debated. One prominent theory suggests they descend from Greek soldiers who settled in southern India after Alexander's invasion, pointing to thier distinct fair complexions and martial traditions reflective of Hellenic origins.

Another theory posits that Coorgis emerged from indigenous tribes of the Western Ghats who adopted Indo-Aryan language and customs over centuries. This view emphasizes their close cultural affinities with Kuruba shepherd communities and preservation of unique animistic rituals.

A third theory links Coorgs to Yadava and Indo-Scythian groups migrating south in early medieval times. Proponents highlight similarities in clan names and swordsmanship, suggesting successive waves of migrants blended with native hill dwellers to form the modern Coorg identity.